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(54) **SYSTEM AND METHOD FOR DETERMINING AND COMMUNICATING PRESENCE INFORMATION**

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(71) Applicant: **Twilio Inc.**, San Francisco, CA (US)

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(72) Inventors: **Jeff Lawson**, San Francisco, CA (US); **Evan Cooke**, San Francisco, CA (US); **Robert J. Simutis**, San Francisco, CA (US); **Patrick Malatack**, San Francisco, CA (US); **Kyle Conroy**, San Francisco, CA (US)

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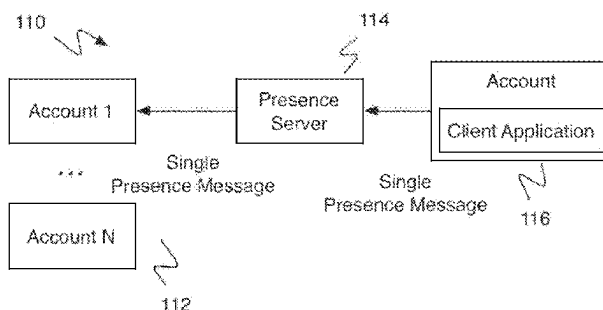
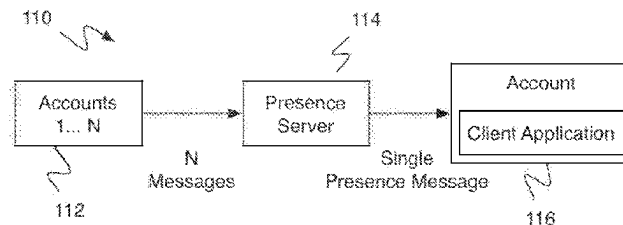
(22) Filed: **Mar. 31, 2025**

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(63) Continuation of application No. 18/631,380, filed on Apr. 10, 2024, now Pat. No. 12,294,674, which is a continuation of application No. 17/950,420, filed on Sep. 22, 2022, now Pat. No. 11,997,231, which is a continuation of application No. 17/070,584, filed on Oct. 14, 2020, now Pat. No. 11,489,961, which is a continuation of application No. 16/845,079, filed on Apr. 10, 2020, now Pat. No. 10,841,421, which is a continuation of application No. 16/245,779, filed on Jan. 11, 2019, now Pat. No. 10,686,936, which is a continuation of application No. 15/911,902, filed on Mar. 5, 2018, now Pat. No. 10,212,275, which is a continuation of application No. 15/337,087, filed on Oct. 28, 2016, now Pat. No. 9,942,394, which is a continuation of application No. 14/946,669, filed on Nov. 19, 2015, now Pat. No. 9,641,677, which is a continuation of application No. 13/624,750, filed on Sep. 21, 2012, now Pat. No. 10,182,147.

(57) **ABSTRACT**

A system and method for communicating presence information that can include at a first server of a communication platform, receiving an authorization token of a first client application; verifying at least one permission associated with the authorization token; registering a presence status of the first client application upon verifying the at least one permission of the authorization token; at a second server of the communication platform, accepting an incoming communication request; retrieving communication instructions according to the incoming communication request; identifying an instruction to communicate with a communication destination of the first client application; accessing the presence status resource of the first client application; establishing communication with the first client application according to the accessed presence status resource.



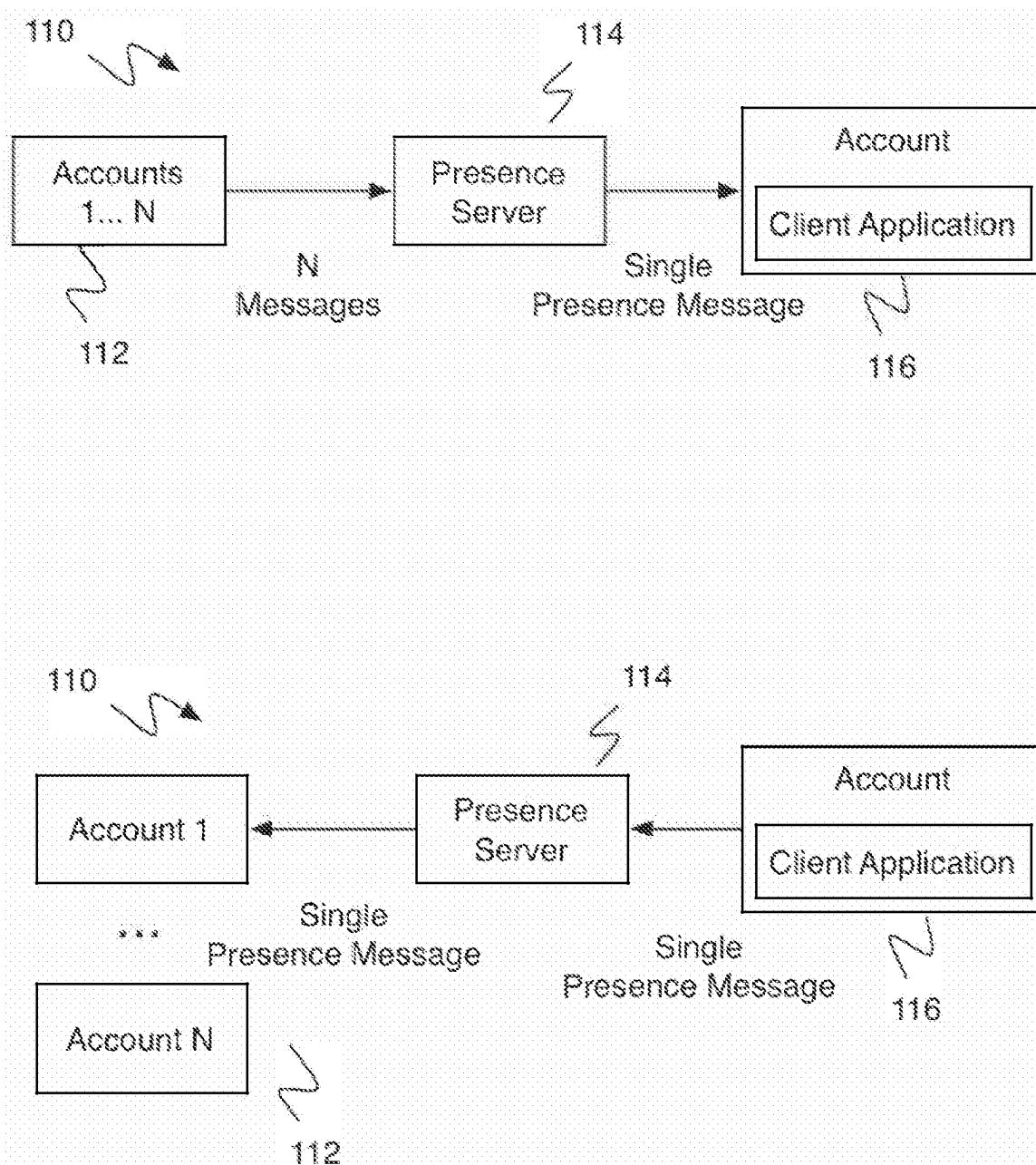


FIGURE 1

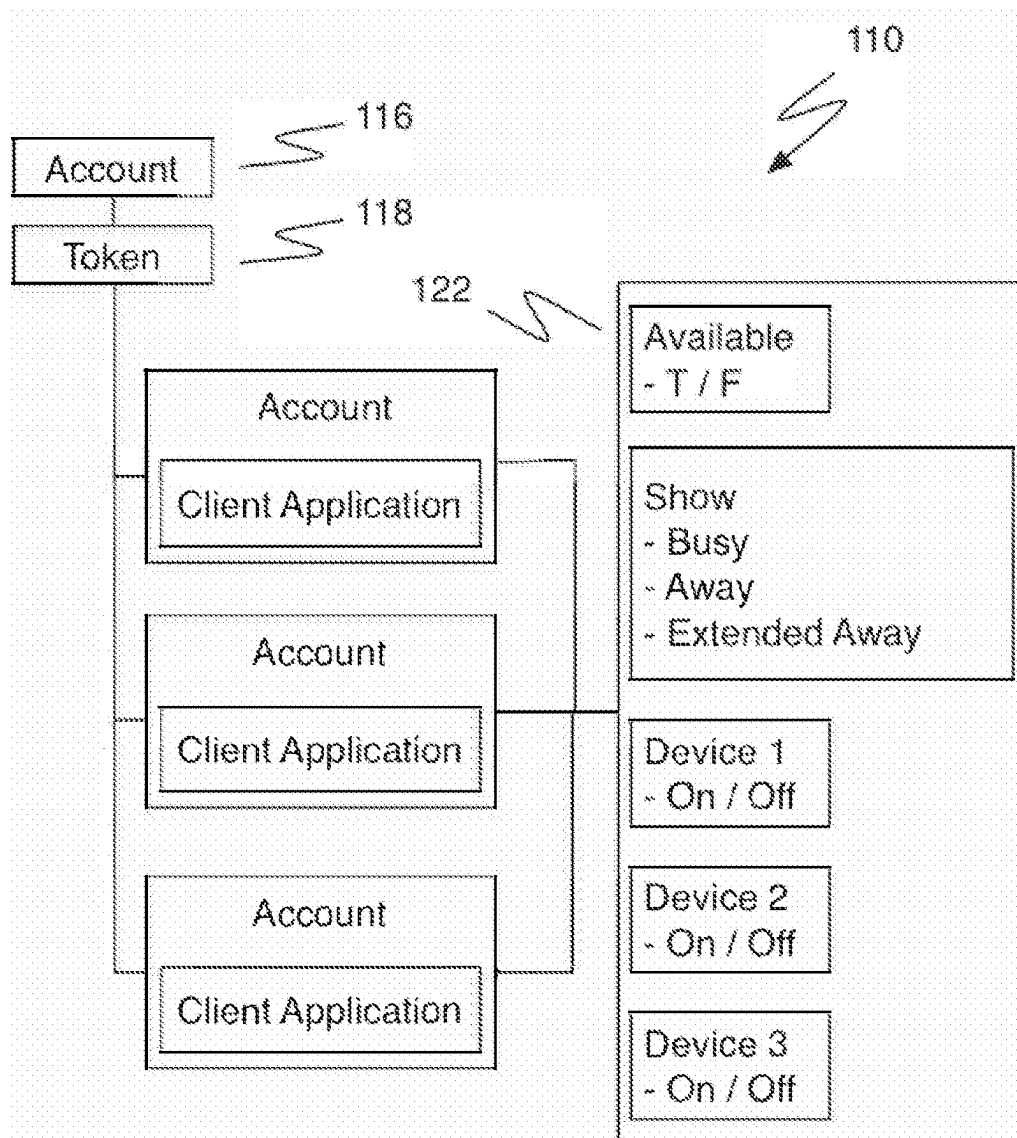
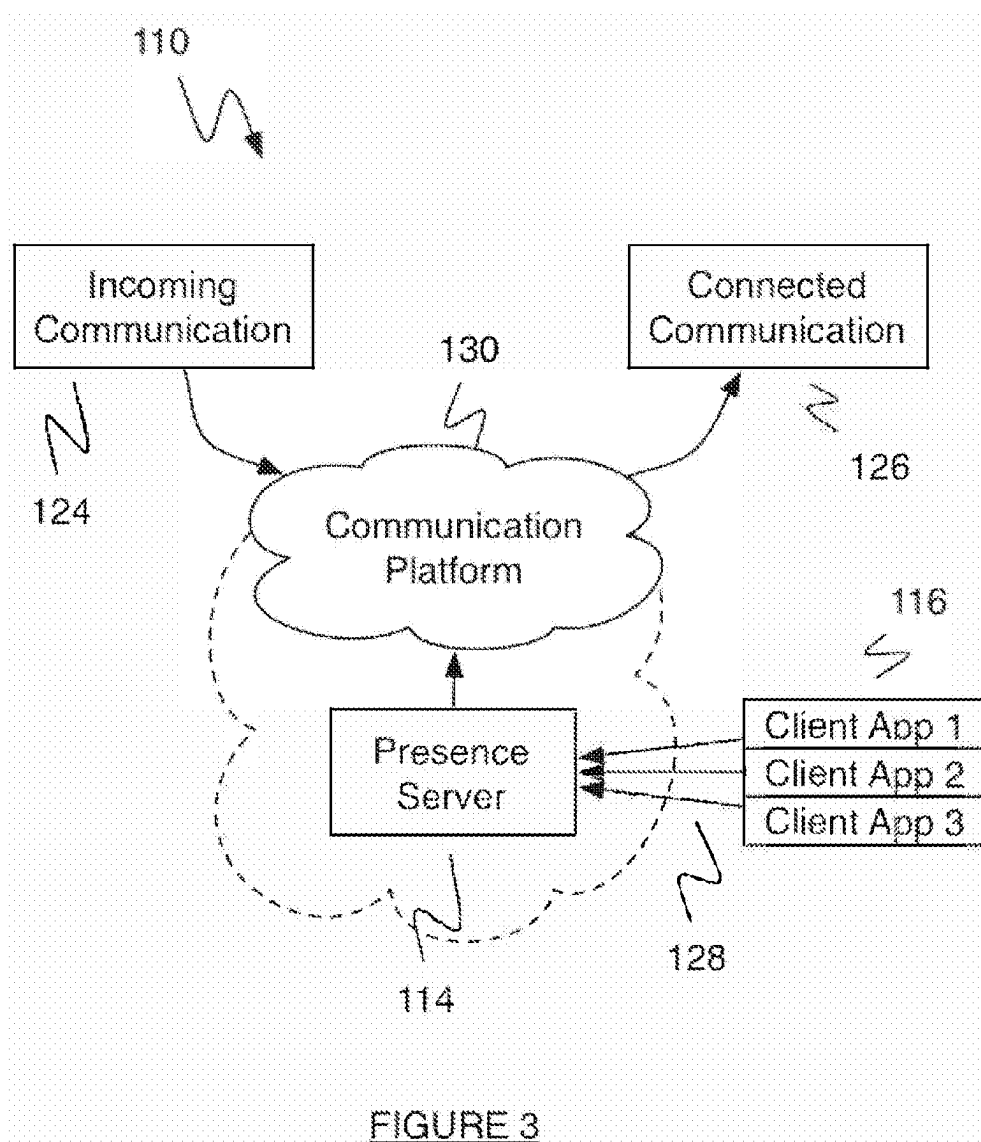


FIGURE 2



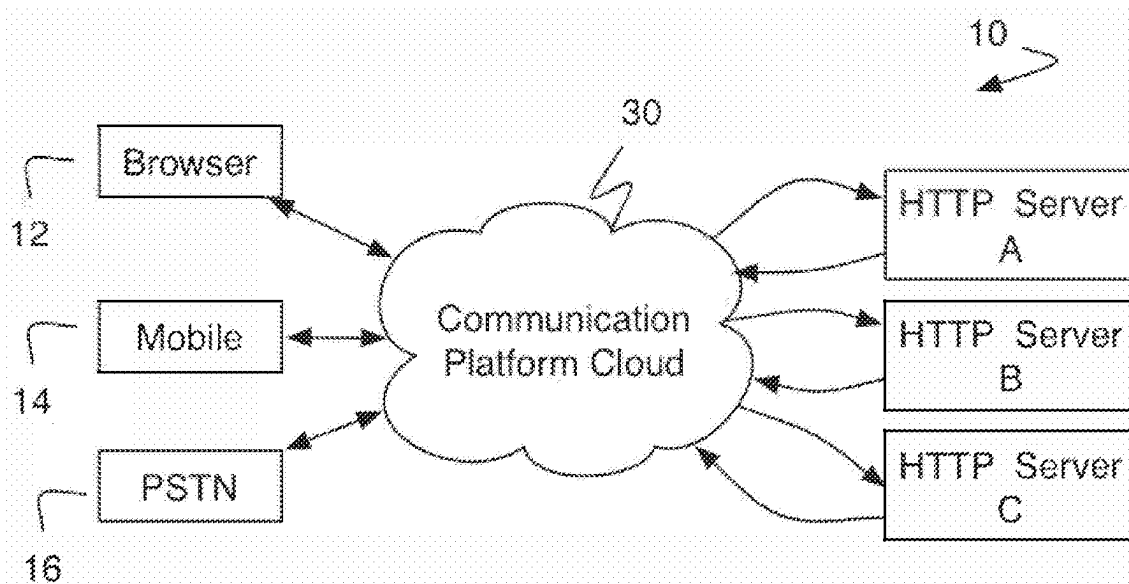


FIGURE 4

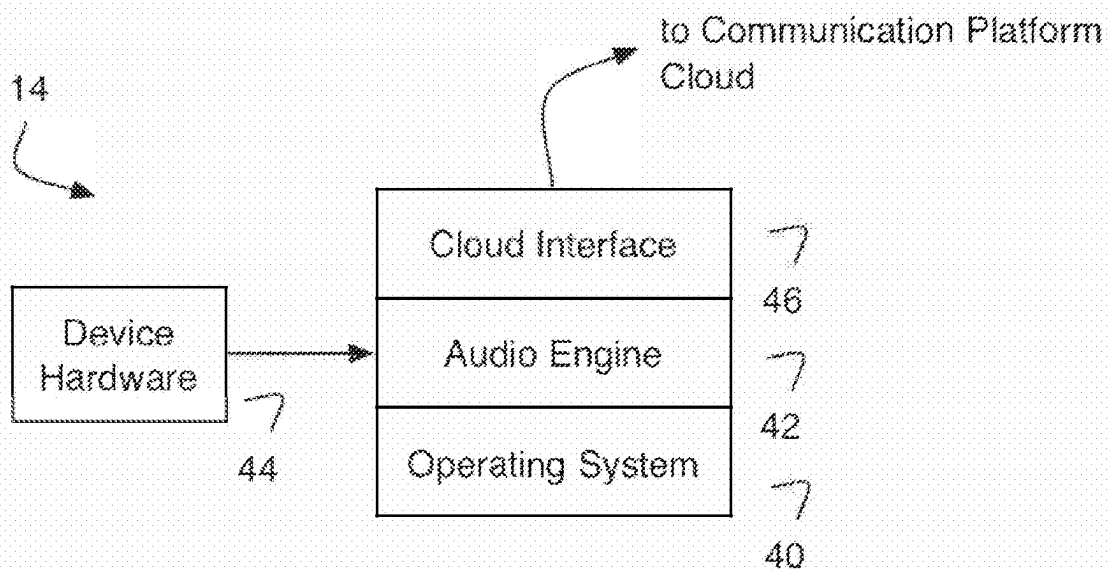


FIGURE 5

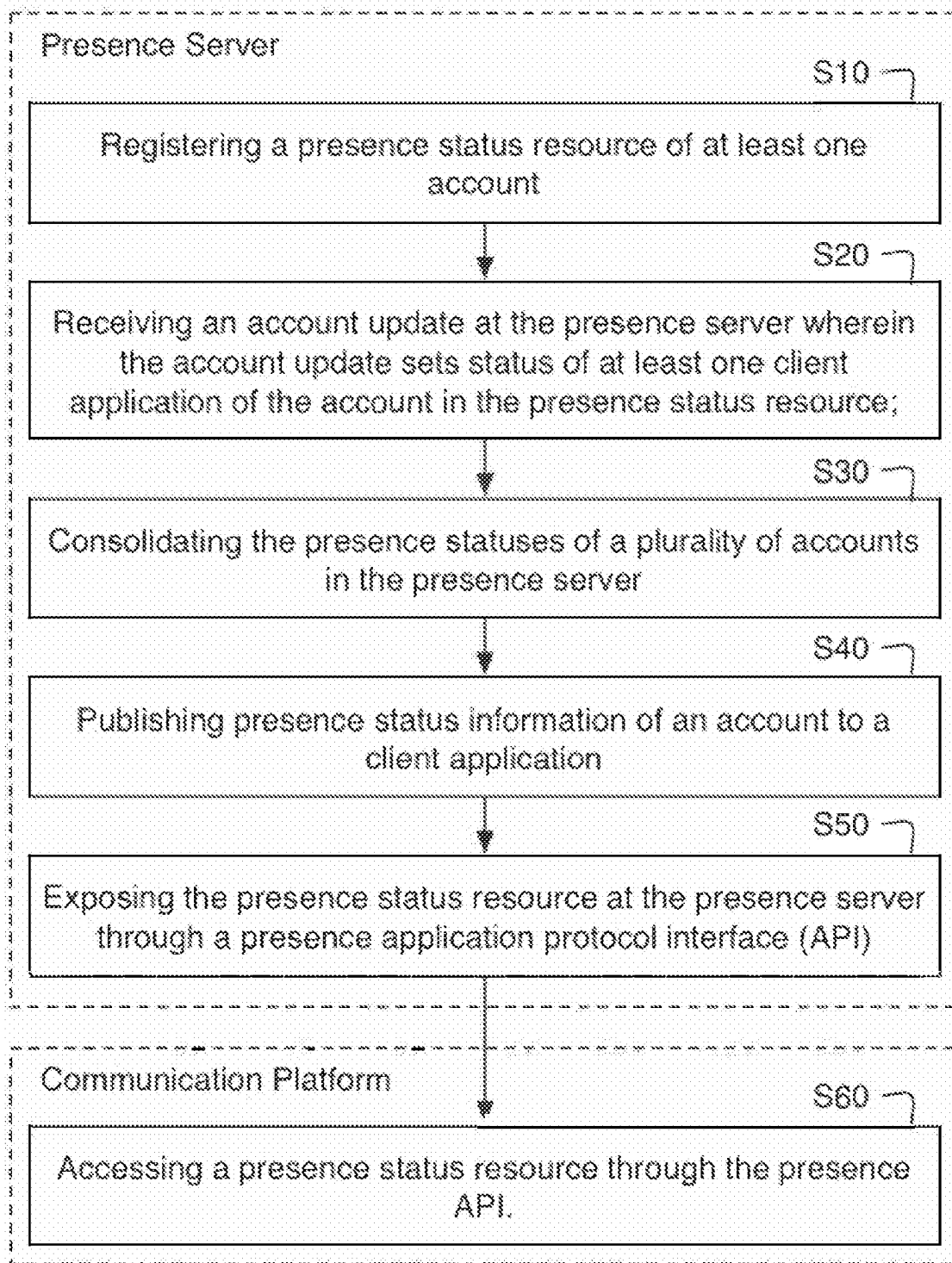
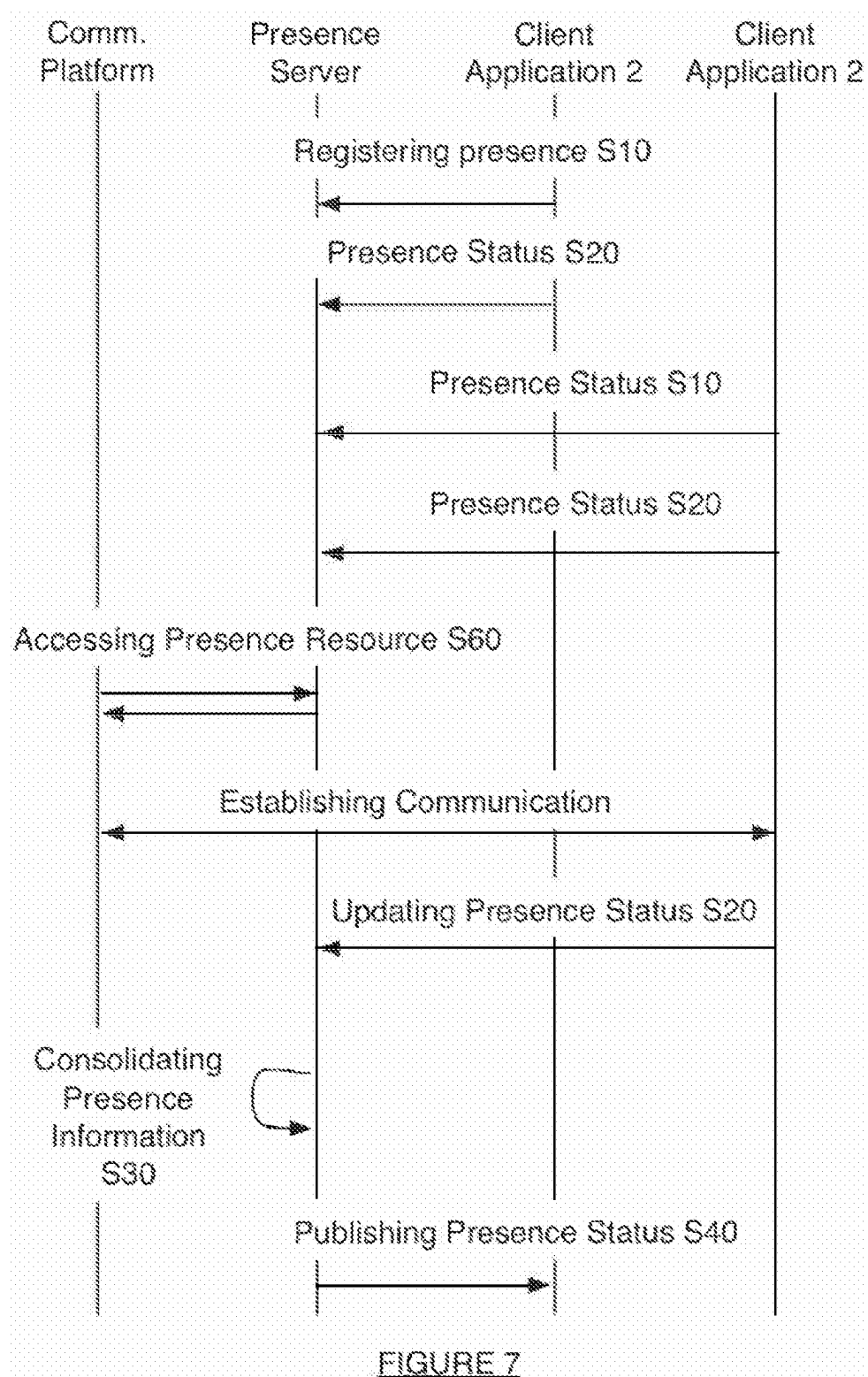


FIGURE 6



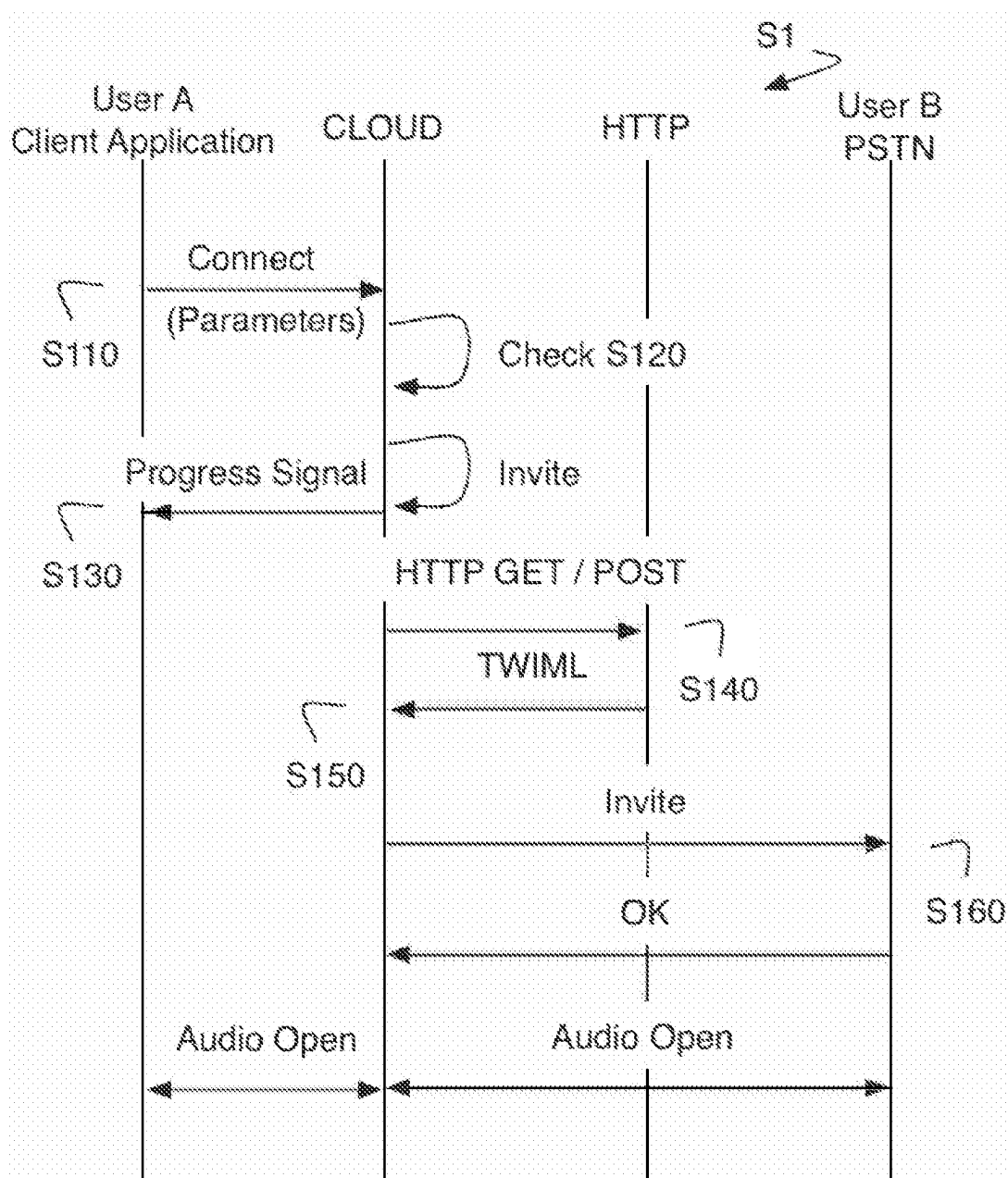


FIGURE 8

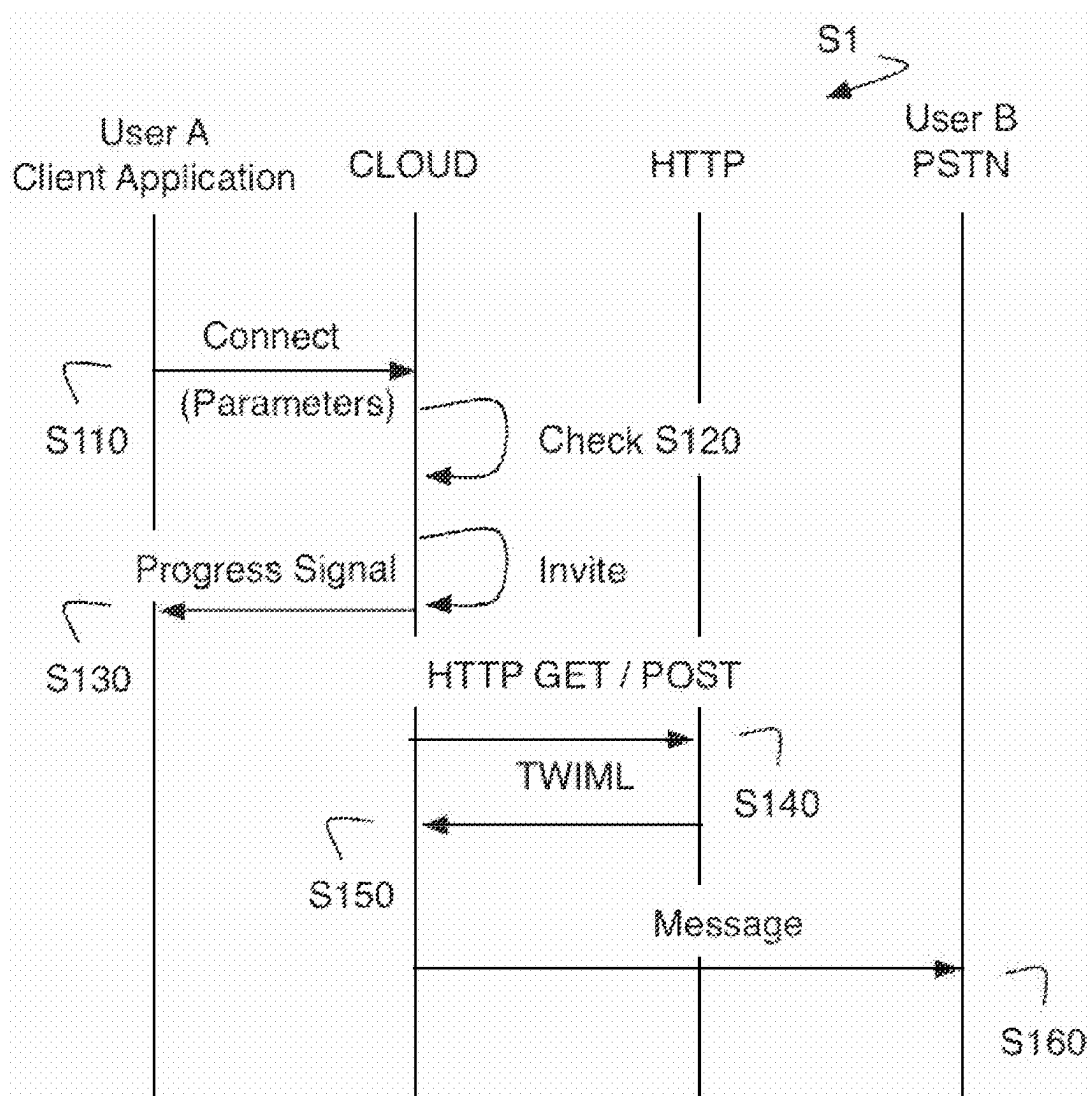


FIGURE 9

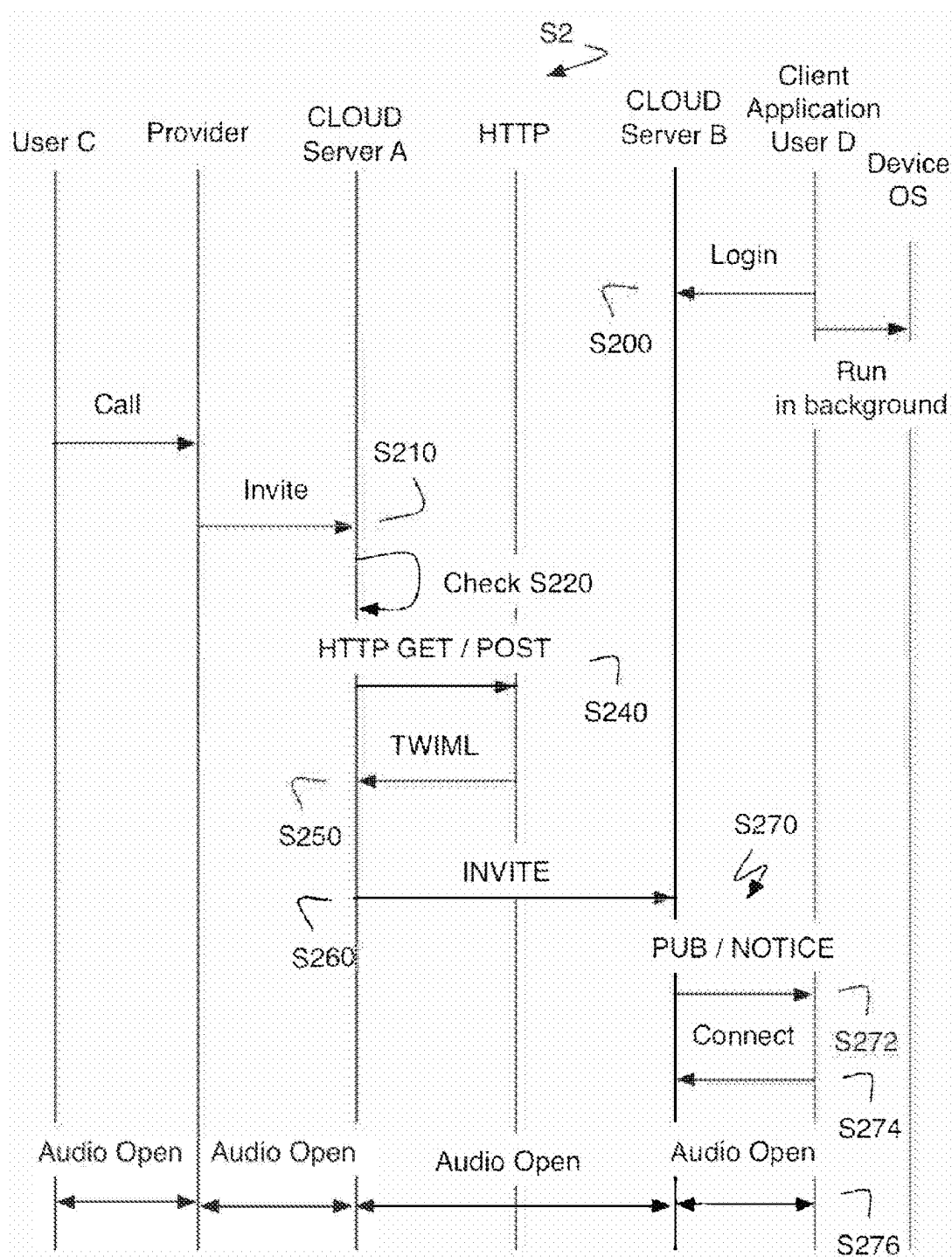


FIGURE 10

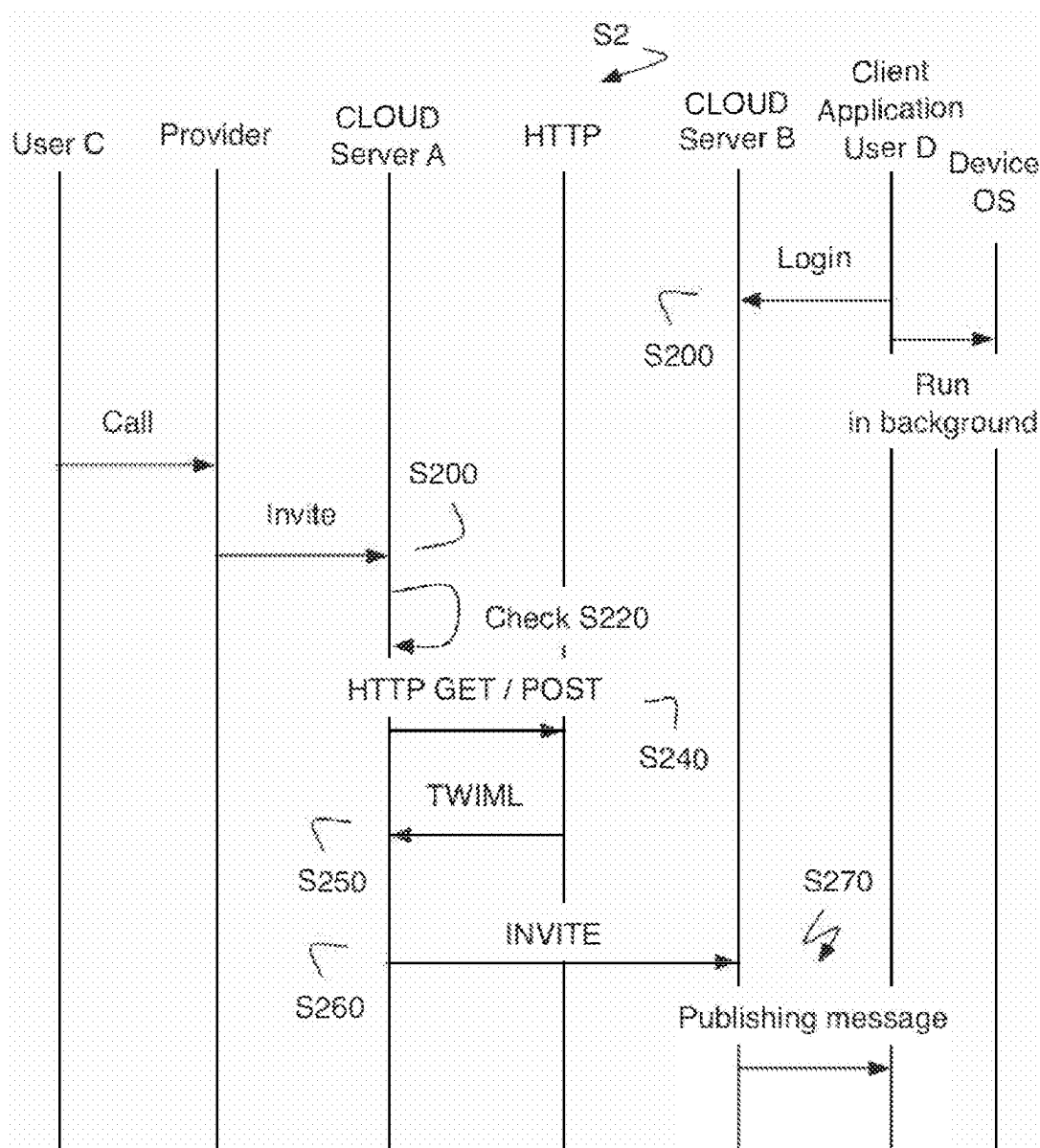


FIGURE 11

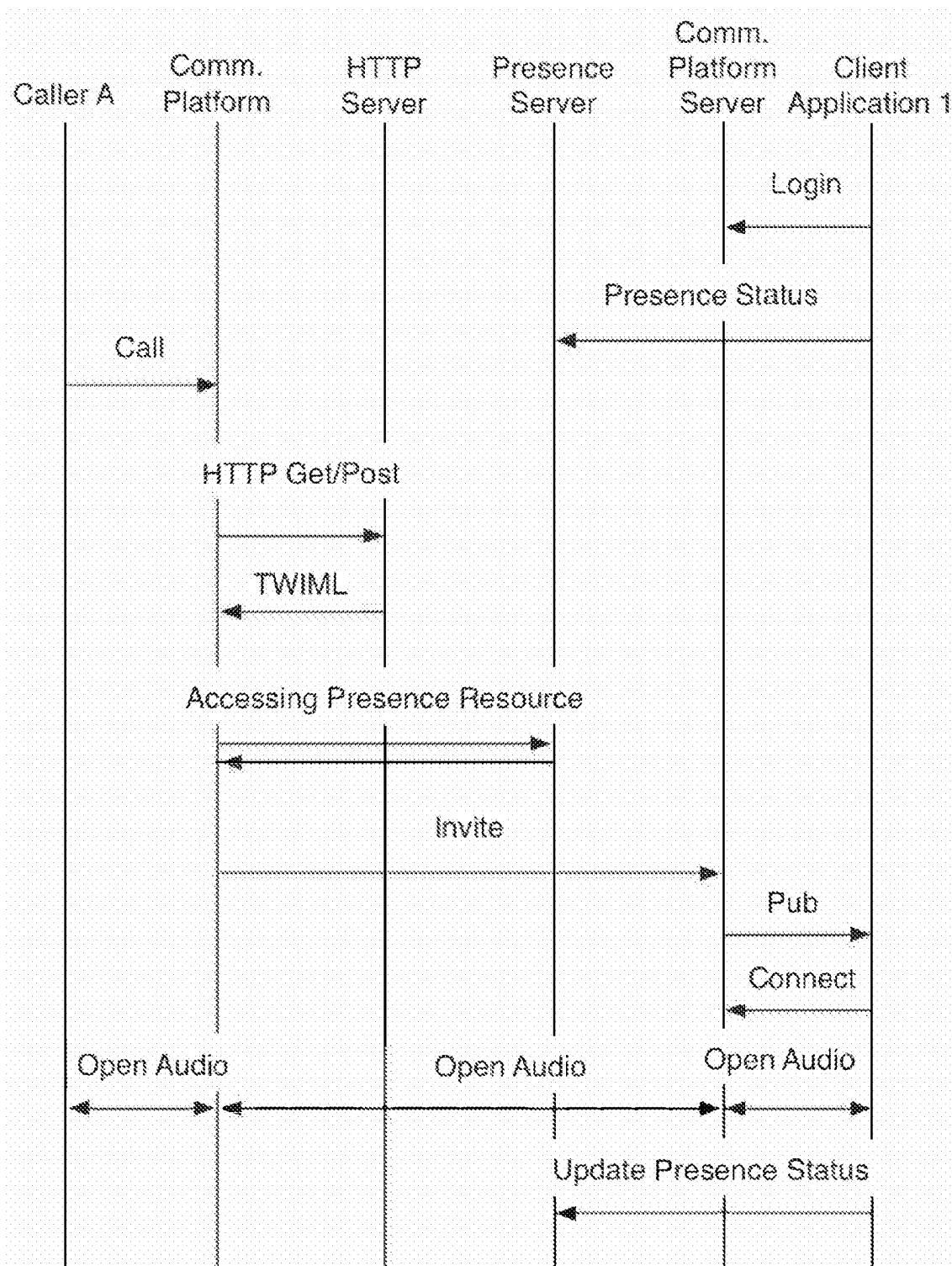


FIGURE 12

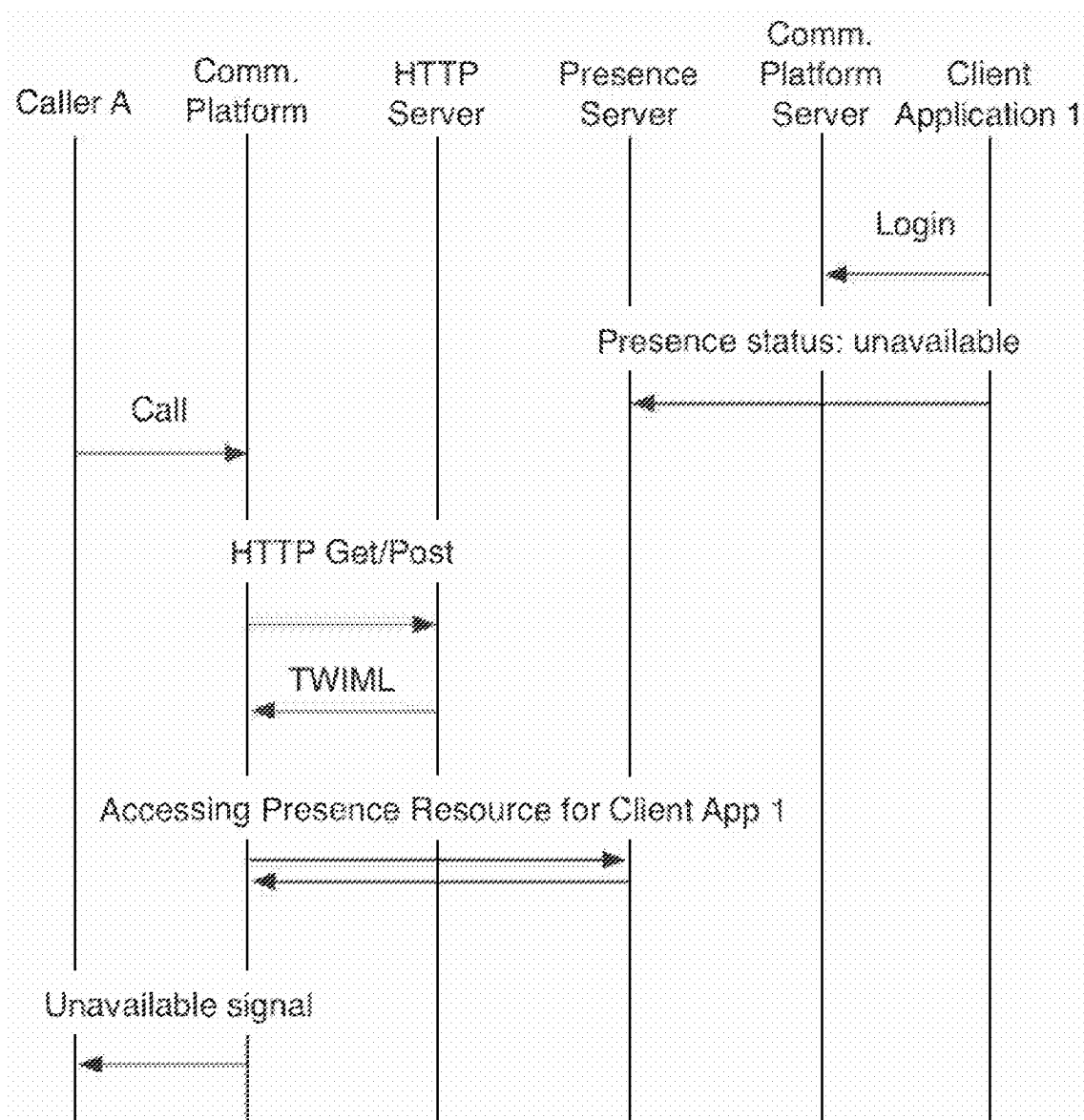


FIGURE 13

SYSTEM AND METHOD FOR DETERMINING AND COMMUNICATING PRESENCE INFORMATION

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

[0001] This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/631,380 filed 10 Apr. 2024, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/950,420 filed 22 Sep. 2022 and issued as U.S. Pat. No. 11,997,231 on 28 May 2024, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/070,584 filed 14 Oct. 2020 and issued as U.S. Pat. No. 11,489,961 on 1 Nov. 2022, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/845,079, filed 10 Apr. 2020 and issued as U.S. Pat. No. 10,841,421 on 17 Nov. 2020, which is a continuation of Ser. No. 16/245,779, filed 11 Jan. 2019 and issued as U.S. Pat. No. 10,686,936 on 16 Jun. 2020, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 15/911,902, filed 5 Mar. 2018 and issued as U.S. Pat. No. 10,212,275 on 19 Feb. 2019, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 15/337,087, filed 28 Oct. 2016 and issued as U.S. Pat. No. 9,942,394 on 10 Apr. 2018, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 14/946,669, filed 19 Nov. 2015 and issued as U.S. Pat. No. 9,641,677 on 2 May 2017, which is a continuation of co-pending U.S. patent application Ser. No. 13/624,750, filed 21 Sep. 2012 and issued as U.S. Pat. No. 10,182,147 on 15 Jan. 2019, which claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Application No. 61/537,223, filed 21 Sep. 2011, and U.S. Provisional Application No. 61/537,217, filed 21 Sep. 2011, all of which are incorporated in their entirety by this reference.

TECHNICAL FIELD

[0002] This invention relates generally to the telephony field, and more specifically to a new and useful system and method for determining and communicating presence information in the telephony field.

BACKGROUND

[0003] In recent years, telephony and messaging applications have spread into numerous settings including peer-to-peer computer-based telephony and messaging services. One feature of some systems relates to determining the availability or presence of a user to receive and/or engage in a communication. In order to determine and communicate this presence information, a user's terminal will repeatedly transmit his or her availability to a presence server, which then redirects that status to each and every contact of the user. Similarly, each of the user's contacts is constantly and repeatedly transmitting its presence information back to the user and each of their respective contacts. The resultant traffic of presence information grows geometrically with each additional user and contact, thereby consuming vast network and server resources while providing very little useful information at the margin. Additionally, including such functionality can require considerable engineering resources and some cases a physical presence of a server on site to support the presence functionality. Thus, there is a need in the telephony field to create a new and useful system and method for determining and communicating presence information. This invention provides such a new and useful system and method.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE FIGURES

[0004] FIG. 1 a schematic block diagram of a system for determining and communicating presence information of a preferred embodiment of the present invention;

[0005] FIG. 2 is a schematic block diagram of additional aspects of the system for determining and communicating presence information of a preferred embodiment of the present invention;

[0006] FIG. 3 is a schematic diagram of additional aspects of the system for determining and communicating presence information of the preferred embodiment of the present invention;

[0007] FIG. 4 a schematic block diagram of a system for connecting a call of a preferred embodiment of the present invention;

[0008] FIG. 5 is a schematic block diagram of a mobile architecture operable in the system for connecting a call of a preferred embodiment of the present invention;

[0009] FIG. 6 is a flowchart depicting a method for determining and communicating presence information of a preferred embodiment of the present invention;

[0010] FIG. 7 is a schematic diagram of a method for detecting and communicating presence information of a preferred embodiment of the present invention;

[0011] FIG. 8 is a schematic diagram of a method for making an outgoing media channel communication from a client application of a preferred embodiment of the present invention;

[0012] FIG. 9 is a schematic diagram of a method for sending an outgoing message from a client application of a preferred embodiment of the present invention;

[0013] FIG. 10 is a schematic diagram of a method for establishing a media channel communication with a client application of a preferred embodiment of the present invention;

[0014] FIG. 11 is a schematic diagram of a method for sending a message communication to a client application of a preferred embodiment of the present invention; and

[0015] FIGS. 12 and 13 are schematic diagrams of variations of a method for detecting and communicating presence information of a preferred embodiment of the present invention.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PREFERRED EMBODIMENTS

[0016] The following description of the preferred embodiments of the invention is not intended to limit the invention to these preferred embodiments, but rather to enable any person skilled in the art to make and use this invention.

1. System for Determining and Communicating Presence Information

[0017] As shown in FIG. 1, a system 110 for determining and communicating presence information can function to determine and communicate the presence information in a bidirectional manner between one or more accounts 1 . . . N 112 and a client application of an account 116. Preferably, a presence server 114 can function as an intermediary between the accounts 1 . . . N 112 and the client application 116. More particularly, the presence server 114 preferably functions to receive N messages conveying the status of each of the accounts 1 . . . N 112 and convert those N messages into a single message to the client application 116, thereby sub-

stantially reducing the consumption of the presence data. Conversely, the presence server **114** preferably also functions to receive a single message from the client application **116** and convey a single message to each of the accounts **1** . . . **N** **112**, again substantially reducing the data traffic and consumption of presence data. Preferably, the transmissions from the presence server **114** include only a single line of content for use in an API of the type described below.

[0018] In another variation of the system **110** of the preferred embodiment, the system **110** can provide for the determination and communication of presence information associated with one or more devices relating to a single account **112**. An account is preferably a contact within a communication platform or system. A contact may be a name-spaced endpoint or any suitable identifier for a communication destination. As used herein, the term device can include a mobile-based telephony application, a browser-based telephony application, a PSTN telephony device (either wired or wireless), or any suitable combination thereof. As shown in FIG. 2, the account **112** can be associated with a token **118** setting forth and/or containing one or more attributes of the account **112**. As an example, the token **118** can include a definition of account permissions, capabilities, authorizations, security protocols as well as presence information relating to one or more devices. Each device preferably includes a client application that runs and interfaces with the presence server to provide information of an account **112**. Preferably, each of the devices can have its own presence information—that is the account might be present on his or her mobile-based application but not present at his or her browser-based telephony application. In some variations, a single device may be allowed to have two client applications running and indicate different presence information for each client application. For example, a user may have two different applications open on one device that function as communication endpoints for the account, but the user may set availability differently for each.

[0019] As shown in FIG. 2, preferably the presence data **122** can be aggregated for all devices. Alternatively, the presence data **122** can be partitioned by each client application **116** such that an account **112** can only see the presence data for those client applications **116** to which the account **112** is connectable. Preferably, the grouping and/or partitioning of the presence data by device can be established in accordance with the token **118**, which as noted above can function to set the basic rules and parameters of client communication. Preferably, the presence data **122** can include one or more fields that can be populated with minimal information to convey the presence information to the account **112**. As an example, the presence data **122** can include a field indicating whether an account **112** in a contact list is available and whether any one or more client applications **116** (i.e., “devices”) of accounts in a contact list are accessible. Additionally, the presence data **122** can further include a field indicating the transitional status of an account that is unavailable—that is, whether the account is unavailable because he or she is busy (on another call), away from the device (down the hallway), or extended away (lunch, gone home for the day, or on vacation).

[0020] As shown in FIG. 3, the system **110** of the preferred embodiment can be configured in part as a communication platform cloud system **130**, which can be separate from the presence server **114**. Alternatively, the presence server **114** can be integrated into the cloud system **130** and/or consoli-

dated into one or more nodes and/or functions of the cloud system **130**. In one variation of the system **110** of the preferred embodiment, the presence server **114** can compose a portion of the cloud system **130**, such as a cloud-based service such as that available from the assignee of the present application. Preferably, the presence server **114** and/or cloud system **130** is configured according to an Application Programming Interface (API). As used herein, the term API should be understood to mean any combination of software, firmware, and/or hardware that allows two or more software applications (i.e., machine-readable instructions) to communicate with one another. The cloud system **130** is preferably a communication platform that facilitates communication (e.g., telephony/voice sessions, video chatting, SMS messaging). An example API can be configured as a telephony platform such as one substantially similar to the one described in published U.S. Patent Application No. 2009/0252159, titled “SYSTEM AND METHOD FOR PROCESSING TELEPHONY SESSIONS”, assigned to the assignee of the present application, and hereby incorporated in its entirety by this reference. The cloud service may interface with the presence server through an API. The API may be an internal presence API that is only exposed to the cloud system **130**, but the presence server **114** and/or the cloud system **130** may expose an at least partial-access presence API for use by outside devices.

[0021] In another variation of the system **110** of the preferred embodiment, the presence server **114** or presence server portion of the cloud system **130** can be configured to operate in a substantially or entirely RESTful mode. Alternatively, all communications in and out of the presence server can be RESTful in nature in both directions. RESTful is understood in this document to describe a Representational State Transfer architecture as is known in the art. The RESTful HTTP requests are preferably stateless, thus each message communicated between at least the presence server **114** and the client **116** preferably contains all necessary information for the presence information relating to the client. Hardware communications elements such as routers and servers preferably do not need to remember or store previous communications to be aware of the state. Documents, media, and application state are preferably viewed as addressable resources, combined with data provide to the resource via request parameter, such as HTTP GET or HTTP POST parameters, or request body contents. Such request data can include an updated representation of the call resource, or other call state data generated as a result of call router operation, such as digits pressed on the keypad or audio recordings generated.

[0022] State information included with each request can include a unique call identifier, call status data such as whether the call is in-progress or completed, the caller ID of the caller, the phone number called, geographic data about the callers, whether a device is available for communication, and/or any suitable data. Alternatively, a varying level of a RESTful communication (statelessness) can be used, such as by using cookies, session tracking, or any suitable devices to simulate a normal website visitor model. Preferably, data sent with each request can fully enable the application server to determine the next state of the call to execute. RESTfulness preferably does not preclude using an external data source, such as a database, to lookup additional data to log call meta data, or determine application logic.

[0023] As shown in FIG. 3, the cloud system 130 can function to transition incoming communications 124 into connected communications 126 to one or more client applications 116. Preferably, each of the clients 116 can provide a presence stream 128 to the presence server 114, indicating a status of the client application 116 on one or more devices as described above. Preferably, the presence stream 128 is communicated to the cloud system 130 via a simple one line API or single API call. Alternatively, the presence server 114 can be integrated into the cloud system 130 (shown in phantom) such that the presence stream 128 can be communicated to other communications hubs in the cloud system 130 for further organization and/or transmission to contacts of the clients 116. The system 110 of the preferred embodiment preferably operates according to the single line http/API described above, and can be executed between a browser API on the client application 116 side and a cloud-based or distributed API on the cloud 130/presence server 114 side. Preferably, the systems described herein can be applied to voice communication (i.e., PSTN to browser or browser to browser voice communications) presence, although other types of communications such as video, email, SMS, MMS, IP-based messaging, proprietary messaging protocols, and the like can also be considered.

[0024] The system preferably can be configured to perform one or more of the foregoing functions in a computer-readable medium storing computer-readable instructions. The instructions are preferably executed by computer-executable components preferably integrated with the client applications 116, the cloud system 130, and/or the presence server 114. The computer-readable medium can be stored on any suitable computer readable media such as RAMs, ROMs, flash memory, EEPROMs, optical devices (CD or DVD), hard drives, floppy drives, or any suitable device. The computer-executable component is preferably a processor but the instructions can alternatively or additionally be executed by any suitable dedicated hardware device.

2. System for Communicating With a Client Application

[0025] As shown in FIG. 4, a system 10 for communicating with a client application can include one or more hardware interfaces, including for example a browser 12, a mobile device 14, or a public switched telephone network (PSTN) line 16. In the system 10 of the preferred embodiment, each of the hardware interfaces 12, 14, 16 can be connected and/or interconnected with one another through a communication platform cloud-based service 30 such as that available from the assignee of the present application. Preferably, the cloud service 30 is configured according to an Application Programming Interface (API). As used herein, the term API should be understood to mean any combination of software, firmware, and/or hardware that allows two or more software applications (i.e., machine-readable instructions) to communicate with one another. An example API can be configured as a telephony platform such as one substantially similar to the one described in published U.S. Patent Application No. 2009/0252159, titled "SYSTEM AND METHOD FOR PROCESSING TELEPHONY SESSIONS", assigned to the assignee of the present application, and hereby incorporated in its entirety by this reference.

[0026] As shown in FIG. 4, the cloud system 30 functions to communicate with one or more client HTTP servers 18, 20, 22. The cloud system 30 and HTTP server 18, 20, 22

communications are preferably RESTful in nature in both directions. RESTful is understood in this document to describe a Representational State Transfer architecture as is known in the art. The RESTful HTTP requests are preferably stateless, thus each message communicated from the call router to the application server preferably contains all necessary information for operation of the application server and response generation of the application server. Hardware communications elements such as routers and servers preferably do not need to remember or store previous communications to be aware of the state. Documents, media, and application state are preferably viewed as addressable resources, combined with data provide to the resource via request parameter, such as HTTP GET or HTTP POST parameters, or request body contents. Such request data can include an updated representation of the call resource, or other call state data generated as a result of call router operation, such as digits pressed on the keypad or audio recordings generated.

[0027] State information included with each request can include a unique call identifier, call status data such as whether the call is in-progress or completed, the caller ID of the caller, the phone number called, geographic data about the callers, and/or any suitable data. Alternatively, a varying level of a RESTful communication (statelessness) can be used, such as by using cookies, session tracking, or any suitable devices to simulate a normal website visitor model. Preferably, data sent with each request can fully enable the application server to determine the next state of the call to execute. RESTfulness preferably does not preclude using an external data source, such as a database, to lookup additional data to log call meta data, or determine application logic.

[0028] The hardware interfaces 12, 14, 16 function to interface with the human element of the communication through voice, video, short message service (SMS), multimedia messaging service (MMS), proprietary or alternative IP messaging protocols, or other communication means and/or protocols. As an example, the browser 12 can include any web-enabled browser that is capable of receiving and/or transmitting voice signals such as through real time messaging protocol (RTMP) or other suitable TCP-type communication protocols. Alternatively, the browser 12 can include any plug-in enabled browser that is configured for session initiated protocol (SIP) communications that can be transmitted through TCP, UDP and/or other suitable protocols. Similarly, the mobile device 14 can include a SIP module or other suitable communication protocol. Preferably, each of the browser 12 and the mobile device 14 can be connected and/or connectable to the cloud service 30 through any suitable type of network, including but not limited to, wide area networks, local area networks, mobile telephony networks, or any suitable combination thereof. As an example, many current mobile devices 14, such as tablet computers, are connectable to the Internet through both WiFi and mobile telephony (GSM and CDMA) networks.

[0029] The mobile device 14 of the system 10 of the preferred embodiment can include a series of modules relating to its communication function. As shown in FIG. 5, the mobile device 14 of the preferred embodiment can include an operating system module 40, an audio engine 42, and a cloud interface module 46. The operating system module 40 of the mobile device 14 of the preferred embodiment functions to control the general functionality of the mobile device 14, including but not limited to its commu-

nication capabilities. The audio engine **42** of the mobile device **14** of the preferred embodiment functions to control a majority of voice communication functions, including interfacing with any device hardware **44** such as speakers and microphones. In particular, the audio engine **42** can function to initiate and control communication sessions including voice communication sessions using Internet protocol (rather than a typical telephony communication protocol typically used in a mobile device).

[0030] The mobile device **14** of the preferred embodiment can further include a cloud interface module **46** that functions to cooperate with the audio engine **42** to communicate with the cloud service **30** and communicate with other hardware interfaces **12**, **14**, **16**. The cloud interface module **46** can be configured within a browser function of the mobile device **14**, or alternatively as a native application or set of machine executable instructions residing permanently or quasi-permanently in a memory module (not shown) of the mobile device **14**. Preferably, the cloud interface module **46** can be designed according to the RESTful principles described above.

[0031] In one variation of the mobile device **14** of the preferred embodiment, the cloud interface module **46** can further include one or more security and/or resource management tools described in further detail below. Examples of security and/or resource management tools can include an authorization token, which can be defined as an electronic listing of possible privileges for its bearer. A developer or other suitable account holder preferably obtains an account token from the provider of the cloud service **30** and then signs the account token to generate an authorization token. The authorization token can be used to authorize actions when included in communication requests, client registration, client presence registration, and/or any suitable use. The cloud service or any suitable service can preferably verify the authorization token by validating the signature of the authorization token against the account key. Thus enabling possibly untrusted client applications to prove that they are authorized to perform particular actions. Example privileges conferred by a token can include, but are not limited to, a user's abilities to make and/or receive calls, an identification of the application and/or user, and one or more operational parameters that can further define a scope of functions and/or processes performable by the cloud interface module **46**. In one exemplary variation, an authorization token permits a communication request to send one or more communications. In another exemplary variation, an authorization token can permit a communication request to establish a communication session that supports communications selected from audio, video, chat, and/or other suitable communication mediums. In another variation an authorization token can permit presence information to be provided to other devices or to be obtained from other devices or a contact list. In one alternative embodiment, the token can be transmittable in its entirety in the clear. In another alternative embodiment, some or all aspects of the token are encrypted during transmission and are partially or entirely unknown to the user of the mobile device **14**. The cloud service **30** may be substantially agnostic relative to the contents of the token insofar as the contents of the token can be directed entirely to the HTTP server or to an authorization server indicating if the authorization token is allowed. Alternatively, the cloud service **30** can function in part as a

gatekeeper and perform one or more security and/or authenticity checks prior to, during, and/or following a communication session.

[0032] As described above and shown in FIG. **3**, a system for communicating with a client application may additionally include a presence server **114**. The presence server is preferably integrated into the cloud service **30** through an API or any suitable interface. The presence information provided through the presence server is preferably used in processing and/or augmenting the communication of the cloud service **30**. The presence server may alternatively be combined with any suitable component of the cloud service **30**.

[0033] The system preferably implements the below methods in a computer-readable medium storing computer-readable instructions. The instructions are preferably executed by computer-executable components preferably integrated with the mobile devices **12**, **14**, **16**, the cloud system **30**, and the HTTP servers **18**, **20**, **22**. The computer-readable medium can be stored on any suitable computer readable media such as RAMs, ROMs, flash memory, EEPROMs, optical devices (CD or DVD), hard drives, floppy drives, or any suitable device. The computer-executable component is preferably a processor but the instructions can alternatively or additionally be executed by any suitable dedicated hardware device.

3. Method for Detecting and Communicating Presence Information

[0034] As shown in FIGS. **6** and **7**, a method for detecting and communicating presence information of a preferred embodiment may include at a presence server of a communication platform, registering a presence status resource of at least one account **S10**; receiving an account update at the presence server wherein the account update sets status of at least one client application of the account in the presence status resource **S20**; exposing the presence status resource at the presence server through a presence application protocol interface (API) **S50**; and at a communication platform, accessing a presence status resource through the presence API **S60**. The method functions to collect presence/availability information from a plurality of devices and a plurality of users, and enable access to the presence information in a scalable and efficient manner. The cloud based presence server in combination with a cloud communication platform system as described above preferably enables scalable presence-based features in communication applications. A communication platform that is a multitenant environment can preferably provide presence-enabled features to customers and/or developers utilizing the communication platform. The method may further be used to provide presence information to various client applications running on devices. The presence server preferably utilizes an authorization token as described above to enable client applications to register to provide and consume presence information.

[0035] Presence data transmitted to the presence server can include any number N of presence messages for each account and/or client application and/or device pairing, all of which may also be retransmitted at regular intervals. For example, incoming presence data from an outside system can include $N \cdot nT$ data records, where N is the number of accounts and nT is the number of periods/intervals for which presence data is transmitted. The presence server preferably consolidates the presence information and presence updates

to alleviate client applications and other systems from handling the significant amount of presence traffic. In some variations, the method may include publishing the presence information to a client application of an account.

[0036] Step S10, which includes at a presence server of a communication platform, registering a presence status resource of at least one account, functions to receive and establish presence data for an account. The presence data is preferably received in a first format for a plurality of accounts. A client application is preferably responsible for initiating and transmitting a communication to register the presence status of an account. Simultaneously or subsequently, Step S20 may update the status of the client application. In one variation this effectively sets the presence/availability of a device of a user. Additionally, presence status may be assumed for an account from which no contact has been made or a significant time delay has occurred since the last update. Registering a presence status preferably includes setting a publication subscription between the presence server and at least one client application of an account. This publication subscription functions to enable presence information to be delivered and/or received by a device as the presence information changes as described below. As with subsequent communications with the presence server, communication is preferably received in a first format, which can include for example an API format usable with the cloud system 30 described above or an XMPP format used in other applications.

[0037] Preferably, at a presence server or an alternative server of the communication platform, an authorization token is received. The authorization token is preferably received when the client application is attempting to connect. The authorization token is preferably verified to ensure the client application is permitted to perform the intended act of the client application (subscribing to calls, messages, contact list presence updates, and or any suitable action. As described above, authorizing preferably includes signing the authorization token against an account key (shared with the developer/account).

[0038] Step S20, which includes receiving an account update at the presence server wherein the account update sets presence status of at least one client application of the account in the presence status resource, functions to set the availability of an account. As mentioned above the presence status may be set during initial presence communication from a client application or account. The initial presence communication preferably indicates the identity of the account and if the account or client application is available or not available.

[0039] Subsequent updates can be received when a presence status change occurs in a client application of an account. Thus, whenever a device of an account has a status change the presence server preferably receives an account update that includes the change. Rather than consume copious amounts of network resources, a client application only updates a presence communication if and when there is a need to do so. Using the API and HTTP modus described herein, the method of the preferred embodiment preferably only alters a presence status resource in response to an affirmative change in such a state received by the client. Absent any change in the client's presence, then the method of the preferred embodiment will take no action and thereby consume fewer resources at the presence server and/or cloud service.

[0040] Presence status of an account may include the presence status of all associated client applications. Alternatively, the presence status of an account may be based on an assessment of the presence status of the client applications. In one variation, different presence statuses (e.g., available, busy, do not disturb, unavailable) may have different priority, and the presence status of an account may be set based on the highest priority of the individually set presence status of the client applications of an account. For example, if a user has two devices, one set to available and one set to do-not-disturb, the account presence status is preferably set to available since the user has one device set to available. Any suitable logic may be used to determine account presence status based on presence status of client applications of the account.

[0041] In another variation of Step S20, the presence status can include an additional natural language description of the status of the client application or account, apart from the binary rendition of whether or not the client is available. For example, a client Romeo can be available and also have an additional status, "wooing Juliet." Juliet, one of Romeo's contacts, can have the additional natural language status, "expecting roses," or the like. The presence status can also include attributes for presently unavailable contacts, such as busy, away (short term), and away (long term.) These attributes can be communicated in lieu of or in addition to the natural language status of the client. Accordingly, client Juliet can have a presence profile that indicates she is away (long term) in concert with a natural language status indicating that she is "asleep" and therefore not permanently away. Similarly, the client Romeo can have a presence profile that indicates that he is away in concert with a natural language status indicating that he is "on his way to Verona," in case any other contacts need to reach him directly. In another example configuration, Romeo and Juliet can have joint presence statuses, for example if they are on a conference call with one another both clients will have a busy attribute. Similarly, Romeo and Juliet can use the same natural language status for joint events, such as "star-crossed."

[0042] Additionally the method of a preferred embodiment may include consolidating the presence statuses of a plurality of accounts in the presence server S30. Step S30 functions to combine and simplify the disparate and innumerable presence status resources of the presence server. The presence server preferably includes presence information for a plurality of accounts, and an account may have presence information for a plurality of client applications/devices. In the application where a client application requires the presence information for a contact list of accounts, there is considerable presence information that is required. The presence server preferably consolidates the presence data of the various accounts into a single API style message to more effectively and efficiently communicate the necessary presence information to the consumer of presence status resource of the presence server (e.g., the client application). The presence server may alternatively consolidate presence information of client applications for an account or perform any suitable consolidation of presence data. The consolidated presence statuses are preferably published or otherwise transmitted to a client application, but may alternatively be accessed as a resource through the presence API. Consolidated presence statuses may be sent on regular

intervals or more preferably published to subscribed client applications when an update occurs.

[0043] Additionally the method may include publishing presence status information of an account **S40**, which functions to disseminate information from the presence server to interested devices. Step **S40** preferably publishes presence status of accounts in a contact list to a client application that has a subscription. The publication subscription may rely upon a pub/sub system, webhooks or any suitable mechanism for communicating messages to a client application. The published presence status information is preferably published as a consolidated message. Similar to how client applications can update presence status when there is a change, the presence server preferably publishes presence status information when there is a change in presence status information. In one variation, contact lists and updates to contact lists are published to client applications.

[0044] Step **S50**, which includes exposing the presence status resource at the presence server through a presence application protocol interface (API), functions to enable devices to interact and utilize the information of the presence server. All communication with the presence server is preferably performed through the presence API though alternative mechanisms may be used. For example, the consolidated presence information is preferably communicated through an API styled message. Client applications can additionally use a provided library or SDK to facilitate interfacing with the presence API. The presence status publication subscriptions may additionally be provided through the presence API. Preferably, the presence server is configured to operate with any API in a RESTful manner as defined and described above.

[0045] Step **S60**, which includes at a communication platform, accessing a presence status resource through the presence API, functions to integrate the presence information into the operation of a communication platform. The communication platform preferably accesses the presence status resources to augment behavior of the communication platform and/or provide insight into presence information for users of the communication platform. The communication platform preferably functions in a manner substantially similar to the methods described below in methods **S1** and **S2**. In one variation of the method of the preferred embodiment, the presence server can be unique and disintegrated from any other suitable communication platform such as a cloud based telephony services. The communication platform in this variation may use a public presence API available to other components. In another variation of the method of the preferred embodiment, the presence server can be integrated into a larger communication such as a cloud based telephony service. The communication platform in this variation may use private and/or public presence API mechanisms to access and interact with the presence information of the presence server. Preferably, the communication platform will access presence status resources when processing logic of a communication application, and modify communication according to presence information access from the presence server. For example, the communication platform may route to a different device, change mediums of a communication, route a call or message to a different account, or perform any suitable action. The communication platform preferably communicates with a client application which preferably functions to provide presence

information as well as serve as a communication endpoint for outgoing or incoming communication.

[0046] The method of the preferred embodiment can be configured partially or entirely in a computer-readable medium storing computer-readable instructions. The instructions are preferably executed by computer-executable components preferably integrated with a mobile devices, one or more portions of the cloud system and the presence server. The computer-readable medium can be stored on any suitable computer readable media such as RAMs, ROMs, flash memory, EEPROMs, optical devices (CD or DVD), hard drives, floppy drives, or any suitable device. The computer-executable component is preferably a processor but the instructions can alternatively or additionally be executed by any suitable dedicated hardware device.

4. Method for Connecting a Call to a Client

[0047] As shown in FIGS. **8** and **9**, a method **S1** of a first preferred embodiment for making outgoing communications from a client application can include receiving a connection request from a first client application **S110**; verifying at least one parameter of the communication request **S120**; transmitting a progress signal to the first client application **S130**; retrieving communication instructions from a server according to the incoming communication request **S140**; identifying an instruction to make a call to a communication destination **S150**; and establishing communication with the communication destination **S160**. The method of the first preferred embodiment enables a client application to establish communication. The medium of communication is preferably a telephony based communication but may alternatively be any suitable communication medium such as video session, screen sharing, text messaging, and/or multimedia messaging. The method preferably establishes a media channel (i.e., communication session) such as an open voice channel between the first client application and at least a second endpoint. The method may alternatively perform one or more communication requests such as transmitting a message from the first client application to at least a second endpoint. As shown in FIG. **8**, the method may be used for connecting a USER A that is using a client application to a USER B that is using a PSTN device. As shown in FIG. **9**, the method may alternatively, be used for communicating a media message such as an SMS or MMS message from a USER A on a client application to a USER B using a PSTN device. The method as described herein, USER A can include a mobile device **14** of the type described above. USER B may be a PSTN connected device or a mobile device **14** of the type described above.

[0048] Step **S110**, which includes receiving a connection request from a first client application, functions to connect a USER A of client application to the CLOUD. The CLOUD is preferably a communication platform and can include one or more functions and/or hardware systems described above with reference to cloud service **30**. Preferably, the CLOUD can include one or more separate servers and/or services configured for trafficking and connecting communications between the users in accordance with the principles of the API described above. The connection Step **S110** functions to initiate communications over a predetermined protocol, such as SIP, RTMP and the like, between a mobile device and the CLOUD. The predetermined protocol is preferably an internet protocol utilizing an internet protocol such as TCP, UDP, and/or HTTP, but any suitable protocol may be used.

[0049] In one variation of the method of the preferred embodiment, the connecting step **S110** can further include transmitting one or more permissions, parameters or tokens with the connection attempt. Preferably, the parameters can include one or more of a cloud system token (or security credential token) that can contain authentication credentials of USER A, a bridge token (which can have a null value in outgoing calls such as that shown in FIG. 8), and/or one or more user-defined parameters. The authentication token is preferably associated with security credentials that can authenticate and/or authorize a communication request to perform particular actions. The authorization token can preferably be used to verify if a bearer can perform a particular action and in some variations which operations to limit/permit. A communication request can be permitted to execute one or more communications. Any suitable restriction on the communications may additionally be associated with the authorization token such as number of communications, timing of communications, communication endpoints, and communication mediums. As described above, the authorization token is preferably created for a client application by a developer signing against their account key or some other suitable identifier. At the communication platform or at a service communicatively coupled to the communication platform, the authorization token can be verified against an account key provided to a developer or provider of a system using the client application. As an example, the user defined parameters can include additional constraints or conditions on the use of the system, such as for example particular users to whom calls can be placed, particular abilities of the token holder, identifiers of any applications or functions in use, or identifiers of any required recipients of communications, e.g., customer service or sales representatives. Preferably, any or all of the permissions can be consolidated into a single entity, such as the cloud system token; and any or all of the permissions can be sealed and kept invisible from USER A and partially or entirely transparent to any intermediary servers useable in the communication process.

[0050] Step **S120**, which includes verifying at least one parameter of the communication request, functions to check if the connection request should be completed. Preferably, the connection request is sent with a security credential token for a user of the first client application. The security credential token is preferably checked at the CLOUD to ensure the client application is allowed to make a connection request on behalf of the user. Permissions can be stored in association with an authorization token, and the authorization token preferably received in **S110** is used to retrieve the associated permissions. The permissions are then used to determine if the communication request is allowed. Additionally or alternatively, the user defined parameters may be checked to ensure they satisfy any requirements or meet expectations. Additionally, step **S120** can preferably function to check other diagnostic functions of the communication system and identify selected ports and/or communication channels for the impending communications. For example, the CLOUD may check to ensure that the connection request is not being made when the CLOUD is an overloaded state, and that the connection request satisfies an overload policy.

[0051] Step **S130**, which includes transmitting a progress signal to the first client application, functions to transmit a ringtone or confirmation message to USER A. The progress

signal may take different forms depending on the communication medium. For voice or video calls, the progress signal is preferably a ringtone played for the user of the client application. In an asynchronous messaging application, the progress signal may indicate the delivery status of the message (e.g., sending, delivered, read). In some variations, the progress signal is a confirmation transmission to confirm the connection for the client application. The confirmation transmission is preferably transparent to a user and is only an acknowledgment by the CLOUD for the client application. The progress signal is preferably transmitted in response to an invite transmission within one or more of the CLOUD service. Preferably, the invite can include an application to which connection is sought, the account identification of the recipient, as well as the user defined parameters that were previously received in the CLOUD. Additionally, the invite can include a caller-identification or user identification of USER A. The invite is preferably a SIP invite but may be any suitable invite. In response to a smooth traffic flow of the invite within the one or more CLOUD servers, the CLOUD can preferably transmit the progress signal back to the mobile device via the SIP connection.

[0052] Step **S140**, which includes retrieving communication instructions from a server according to the incoming communication request, functions to fetch instruction markup determining communication logic. Step **S140** preferably includes transmitting an HTTP request (such as a GET or POST) to the HTTP Server associated with the user account of the client application. Preferably the user account has a URL configured as a resource location of the communication instructions. Step **S140** can preferably be performed simultaneously or substantially simultaneously with one or more variations of step **S130**, described above. In another variation of the method of the preferred embodiment, the HTTP request can include any or all of the permissions described above. Preferably, the HTTP request includes at least the user-defined parameters, which can be transmitted and received in an encrypted format. Alternatively, step **S140** can include verifying one or more of the user defined parameters at or by the HTTP server.

[0053] Step **S150**, which includes identifying an instruction to make a call to a communication destination, functions to process the communication instructions and determine an outgoing communication destination. The communication instructions retrieved in Step **S140** are preferably transmitted as a markup language format message to the CLOUD from the HTTP Server. In one variation of the method of the preferred embodiment, the markup language format message can include one of an HTML message, an XHTML message, an SGML message, or any other suitable markup language or variation or version thereof. In another variation of the method of the preferred embodiment, the markup language format message can include a TWiML message for use with a cloud system of the assignee of the present application. The communication instructions may include any suitable logic. In making an outgoing call, the communication instructions preferably include an instruction to dial or communicate with a communication destination.

[0054] Step **S160**, which includes establishing communication with the communication destination, functions to complete communication with the desired endpoint. Establishing communication can establish communication from the source of the communication request (e.g., USER A) and at least one party/endpoint. A plurality of destination end-

points/parties may alternatively be included in the established communication. In a first variation, the communication is preferably an open media channel (e.g., voice/audio, video, screen sharing or any suitable communication session) between the client application and a device of the communication destination. This variation preferably includes inviting the communication destination; and upon receiving acknowledgement of invite acceptance, opening a media channel between the communication destination and the first client application. The invite is preferably a SIP invite but may alternatively be any suitable invite to a media channel. This may be used to establish communication with a PSTN device and/or a second client application as described more below. In one example, a USER A is attempting to contact a PSTN USER B. Accordingly, the communication instructions can indicate that the recipient is a PSTN user, and therefore the CLOUD will preferably create an appropriate SIP invite and transmit it to an appropriate provider. As used herein, the PSTN network and/or service provider can include both mobile and landline-based telephony networks. A response is preferably received from the provider at the CLOUD service, wherein the response can include an appropriate HTTP status code such as 200 OK. Following confirmation and cross-confirmation between one or more components of the CLOUD service and the service provider, the method can open a media channel between USER A and USER B. As shown in FIG. 8, the media channel bypasses and/or is transparent to the HTTP server, but can be transmitted through one or more components of the CLOUD service. It should be understood that the media channel can also include other types of media, including at least video, screen sharing, SMS, MMS, or any other suitable communication media.

[0055] In a second variation of Step S160, establishing a communication with the communication destination can include performing one or more specific communication requests. Performing the communication request preferably includes sending an asynchronous message to the communication destination as shown in FIG. 9. An asynchronous message can be sent using protocols including SMS, MMS, IP-based messaging protocols, proprietary messaging protocols, and/or any suitable messaging protocol.

[0056] In another variation of the method of the preferred embodiment, USER A can be communicating on a mobile device having a native application, software program or set of machine executable instructions that functions to perform one or more of the steps outlined above. In one example configuration, the connect, check and invite steps S110, S120, S130 or significant portions thereof can all be performed by such a native application configured with an operating system of the mobile device. As an example, certain invite and authentication procedures, including for example the cloud system token and user defined parameters associated with the application native to the user's mobile device. In such an example configuration, the mobile device can communicate directly with the HTTP server via one or more requests and/or messages of the type described above.

[0057] As shown in FIGS. 10 and 11, a method S2 of a second preferred embodiment for receiving communication at a client application may include at a first server of a communication platform, receiving an executed login of a user of a first client application S200; at a second server of the communication platform, accepting an incoming communication request S210; retrieving communication instruc-

tions from a server according to the incoming communication request S240; identifying an instruction to make a call to a communication destination of the user of the first client application S250; forwarding the communication request to the first server of the communication platform S260; and at the first server of the communication platform, establishing communication with the first client application S270. The method functions to receive calls at a client application through the systems described above. The method is preferably employed to enable software applications or machine executable instructions running natively on a mobile device to interface with a telephony or communication platform. The method may be used such that a PSTN device or any suitable communication capable device may contact the client application. The method may be used for voice, video, SMS, MMS, IP based messaging, proprietary messaging, and/or any suitable communication medium. The method may be used in combination with the method above for making outgoing communications from a client application such that a first client application may contact a client application. The pairs of steps S110 and S210, S120 and S220, S140 and S240, and S150 and S250 may in some variations be substantially similar to their corresponding step.

[0058] Step S200, which includes at a first server of a communication platform, receiving an executed login of a user of a first client application, functions to establish a connection of a user to a communication platform/CLOUD system. The user preferably uses a mobile device having a native application (with a client application) of the type described above, but any suitable device with a client application may be used. Preferably, when USER D logs into his account on CLOUD B, a URL subscription <userd_sid>/USERD is established in CLOUD B such that USER D will receive any messages published to that URL. Example messages can include voice, video, SMS, MMS, email or any other suitable type of electronic communication audible or readable on a mobile device.

[0059] Step S210, which includes at a second server of the communication platform, accepting an incoming communication request, functions to initiate a call from a caller (e.g., USER C) to the user of the first client application (e.g., USER D). As shown in FIG. 5, the call initiation can be processed at a service provider, such as for example a PSTN service provider for a mobile telephony or landline telephony network. The service provider can function to receive a telephonic communication (voice, SMS, MMS) and convert that incoming communication into an SIP request transmittable to CLOUD A. Alternatively, the caller may be initiated by device using a second client application, and the outgoing call may be established in manner substantially similar to that of the method for making outgoing communications from a client application. In step S220 of the method of the preferred embodiment, CLOUD A will perform a check of the received SIP invite, which can include checking a recipient account, a voice URL for the account, an SMS or MMS URL for the account and/or any other account-specific or user specific permissions or preferences associated with the account of USER D. In the variation where a call is initiated from a second client application, the method S2 may include transmitting a progress signal to the second client application, which is substantially similar to Step S130.

[0060] Steps S240 and S250, which include retrieving communication instructions from a server according to the incoming communication request and identifying an instruction to make a call to a communication destination of the user of the first client application, function to process the application logic of a communication platform application. Step S240 of the method of the preferred embodiment preferably includes transmitting an HTTP request from CLOUD A to the users HTTP Server in response to a successful check of the recipient's credentials. As an example, once CLOUD A identifies a voice URL associated with USER D's account, CLOUD A can transmit an HTTP GET/POST request to USER D's HTTP Server. Step S250 of the method of the preferred embodiment preferably processes the communication instructions and determine an outgoing communication destination corresponding to the user of the first client application. A markup language format message is preferably received at CLOUD A from the HTTP Server. In one variation of the method of the preferred embodiment, the markup language format message can include one of an HTML message, an XHTML message, an SGML message, or any other suitable markup language or variation or version thereof. In another variation of the method of the preferred embodiment, the markup language format message can include a TWiML message for use with a cloud system of the assignee of the present application.

[0061] Step S260, which includes forwarding the communication request to the first server of the communication platform functions to communicate the incoming communication request to a portion of the CLOUD that manages the logged in user. For media channels communication requests such as voice or video calls, an invite request is transmitted from CLOUD A to CLOUD B in response to the receipt of the markup language format message from USER D's HTTP Server. Preferably, the invite request contains at least an account identification for USER D and a client name (USER D) associated with the account during the login step S200. The invite request is preferably a SIP invite as is known in the art. In the case of an asynchronous messaging, the text, and/or media message may be contained in the communication message sent to the server of CLOUD B as shown in FIG. 11. The first server of the communication platform may additionally or alternatively include or function as a subscription manager of the communication platform. The communication request may subsequently be forwarded to an appropriate server to manage the subscription or login session of the user of the first client application.

[0062] Step S270, which includes at the first server of the communication platform, establishing communication with the first client application; functions to complete the communication request initiated in Step S200. Step S270 preferably completes the communication request between the entity of the incoming communication request (e.g., USER C) and the user of the first client application (e.g., USER D). Establishing communication with the first client application preferably includes publishing a notification to the first client application S272. In one variation of the method of the preferred embodiment, CLOUD B can publish an invite message to USER D's URL while simultaneously causing the caller, USER C, to hear a ringtone. In Step S272 CLOUD B can receive the publication of the invite message and broadcast it to all registered listeners, i.e., those users associated with the account established in step S200. Establishing communication with the first client application may

include varying steps depending on if the method is employed for establishing a media channel between two parties or for sending a message from one entity to a user of the first client application.

[0063] Establishing communication for a media channel communication request can additionally include receiving a connection acceptance by the first client application S274; and opening a media channel with the first client application upon connection S276. If USER D agrees to accept the incoming call, then he will transmit a connection acceptance to CLOUD B as shown in step S274. The acceptance can include the transmission of one or more permissions with the connection acceptance. Preferably, the permissions can include one or more of a cloud system token containing the security credentials of USER D (which can have a null value since the call is being received in FIG. 10), a bridge token (which might have been copied from the invitation from CLOUD B), and one or more user defined parameters. In another variation of the method of the preferred embodiment, CLOUD B step S274 can also include checking the one or more permissions at CLOUD B, which can include for example checking if there are a predetermined number of parameters (even though one or more can be null). Alternatively, step S274 can further include unpacking the bridge token to identify an IP address associated with one or more CLOUD A or CLOUD B servers to ensure that communications are properly routed and merged through the appropriate portion of CLOUD A or CLOUD B, i.e., a bridge portion of one of the respective CLOUD services. In another variation of the method or the preferred embodiment, step S274 can include bridging the call between USER C and USER D in response to a bridge token associated with the connection request from USER D.

[0064] In another variation of the method of the preferred embodiment, step S274 can recite responding from the provider to the CLOUD service, wherein the response can include an appropriate HTTP status code such as 200 OK. Following confirmation and cross-confirmation between one or more components of the CLOUD service and the service provider, step S216 of the method of the preferred embodiment recites opening an audio channel between USER C and USER D. As shown in FIG. 10, the audio channel bypasses and/or is transparent to the HTTP server, but can be transmitted through one or more components of the CLOUD A and CLOUD B components.

[0065] In another variation of the method of the preferred embodiment, USER D can be communicating on a mobile device having a native application, software program or set of machine executable instructions that functions to perform one or more of the steps outlined above. In one example configuration, the login, pub/notice and connect steps S200, S272, S274 or significant portions thereof can all be performed by such a native application configured with an operating system of the mobile device. As an example, certain invite and authentication procedures, including for example the cloud system token and user defined parameters associated with the application native to the user's mobile device. In such an example configuration, the mobile device can communicate directly with the HTTP server via one or more requests and/or messages of the type described above.

[0066] Additionally, the method S2 and/or method S1 may be used in combination with the method for communicating presence information as shown in FIG. 12. The method preferably includes steps for communicating presence infor-

mation and additionally steps for receiving communication at a client application. The method preferably comprises at a presence server: registering a presence status resource of at least one account, receiving an account update at the presence server wherein the account update sets status of at least one client application of the account in the presence status resource, and exposing the presence status through a presence application protocol interface (API); and at a communication platform: receiving a connection request from a calling entity, retrieving communication instructions from a server according to the incoming communication request, identifying an instruction communicate with a communication destination, accessing a presence status resource through the presence API, and establishing communication with the communication destination according to the accessed presence status resource. The method may include any suitable combination or variations of the above methods and systems or any suitable alternatives. The authorization token and verifying of the authorization token may be used to both set up the presence status resource of a client application and the communication endpoint of a client device. Thus a client application that executes a login by sending an authorization token can simultaneously set up their presence information and enable the client application to make outgoing communications or receive incoming communications. A publication subscription between the communication platform and the client application may be used for both presence and communication purposes.

[0067] As shown in FIG. 12, the method may be employed to modify communication to a client application or any suitable device with a presence status. The method may be used for media connections such as opening voice or video channels. It may alternatively or additionally be used for messaging such as SMS, MMS, IP-based messaging, proprietary messaging, and/or any suitable messaging protocol. The presence information may be used by the communication platform to alter communication in any suitable manner. The presence of an account is preferably accessed and processed during, in preparation, or as a result of processing communication instructions. The communication instructions may be customized and developed by third parties and have any suitable variations in the application of presence information in communication apps.

[0068] In one variation, the method is used to route to the available client application of an account. For example, user A may call user B, but user B can have three devices associated with the account. The communication platform will preferably use the presence information to determine which of the three devices to connect to user A. This may be used to route to one of a plurality of devices of a user.

[0069] In another variation the method may be used to route to one of a plurality of available accounts. In a call center, customer support agents may all have an account and an active client application. Throughout the day various agents will be busy. The communication platform may intelligently distribute calls to an account based on availability and even how much load (i.e., number of calls an agent has supported).

[0070] In yet another variation, the method may be used to indicate to a caller that the account is not available as shown in FIG. 13. For example, user A may call user B. When the communication platform determines that user A is trying to connect to user B, the communication platform preferably accesses the presence status resource for user B. If user B is

not available as indicated in the presence status resource, then the communication platform preferably transmits an unavailable signal to the user A. The unavailable signal may be a busy signal, a text-to-speech transcription of a message set by user B, or any suitable indicator of the presence information of user B.

[0071] As shown in FIGS. 10 and 11, the cloud services can be broken in to two or more segments, including for example CLOUD A and CLOUD B. Those of skill the art will appreciate that these designations are for illustrative and descriptive ease only, and that CLOUD A and CLOUD B can include a single computer/server having multiple functions or multiple discrete computers/servers having unique functions, depending upon the particular configuration sought by the user. The method of the preferred embodiment can be configured partially or entirely in a computer-readable medium storing computer-readable instructions. The instructions are preferably executed by computer-executable components preferably integrated with a mobile devices, one or more portions of the cloud system and the HTTP servers. The computer-readable medium can be stored on any suitable computer readable media such as RAMs, ROMs, flash memory, EEPROMs, optical devices (CD or DVD), hard drives, floppy drives, or any suitable device. The computer-executable component is preferably a processor but the instructions can alternatively or additionally be executed by any suitable dedicated hardware device.

[0072] As a person skilled in the art will recognize from the previous detailed description and from the figures and claims, modifications and changes can be made to the preferred embodiments of the invention without departing from the scope of this invention defined in the following claims.

1. A method, comprising:

receiving, by a processing device, a communication request initiated by a first account of a communication platform, the communication request specifying a second account of the communication platform;
generating, by consolidating a plurality of messages received via an application programming interface (API), presence data of the second account;
determining, based on the presence data, a presence status of the second account; and
processing the communication request based on the presence status of the second account.

2. The method of claim 1, wherein each of the first account and the second account is associated with a communication application supported by the communication platform.

3. The method of claim 1, wherein the presence data comprises a respective presence status for one or more communication applications running on each of a plurality of devices associated with the second account.

4. The method of claim 1, wherein determining the presence status of the second account further comprises:
selecting a highest priority presence status among a plurality of application present statuses of a plurality of communication applications associated with the second account.

5. The method of claim 1, wherein determining the presence status of the second account further comprises:
identifying, among a plurality of application present statuses of a plurality of communication applications associated with the second account, a subset of com-

munication applications connectable to or more communication applications running on a client device associated with the first account; and selecting a highest priority presence status among a subset of application present statuses of the subset of communication applications.

6. The method of claim 1, further comprising: receiving an API request for accessing the presence data associated with the second account; and returning an API message that includes the presence data in response to the API request.

7. The method of claim 1, further comprising: receiving a plurality of messages associated with a plurality of communication applications associated with the second account, each message of the plurality of messages indicating a presence status of a communication application of the plurality of communication applications; and consolidating the plurality of messages into an API message.

8. The method of claim 1, further comprising: responsive to receiving a login authorization token from a communication application running on a client device associated with the second account, updating the presence data associated with the second account.

9. A system, comprising:
a memory; and
a processing device, coupled to the memory, the processing device configured to:
receive a communication request initiated by a first account of a communication platform, the communication request specifying a second account of the communication platform;
generate, by consolidating a plurality of messages received via an application programming interface (API), presence data of the second account;
determine, based on the presence data, a presence status of the second account; and
process the communication request based on the presence status of the second account.

10. The system of claim 9, wherein each of the first account and the second account is associated with a communication application supported by the communication platform.

11. The system of claim 9, wherein the presence data comprises a respective presence status for one or more communication applications running on each of a plurality of devices associated with the second account.

12. The system of claim 9, wherein determining the presence status of the second account further comprises:
selecting a highest priority presence status among a plurality of application present statuses of a plurality of communication applications associated with the second account.

13. The system of claim 9, wherein determining the presence status of the second account further comprises:
identifying, among a plurality of application present statuses of a plurality of communication applications associated with the second account, a subset of communication applications connectable to or more communication applications running on a client device associated with the first account; and

selecting a highest priority presence status among a subset of application present statuses of the subset of communication applications.

14. The system of claim 9, wherein the processing device is further configured to:

receive a plurality of messages associated with a plurality of communication applications associated with the second account, each message of the plurality of messages indicating a presence status of a communication application of the plurality of communication applications; and

consolidate the plurality of messages into an API message.

15. The system of claim 9, wherein the processing device is further configured to:

responsive to receiving a login authorization token from a communication application running on a client device associated with the second account, updating the presence data associated with the second account.

16. A non-transitory computer-readable storage medium comprising executable instructions that, responsive to execution by a processing device, cause the processing device to:

receive a communication request initiated by a first account of a communication platform, the communication request specifying a second account of the communication platform;

generate, by consolidating a plurality of messages received via an application programming interface (API), presence data of the second account;

determine, based on the presence data, a presence status of the second account; and

process the communication request based on the presence status of the second account.

17. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 16, wherein each of the first account and the second account is associated with a communication application supported by the communication platform.

18. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 16, wherein the presence data comprises a respective presence status for one or more communication applications running on each of a plurality of devices associated with the second account.

19. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 16, wherein determining the presence status of the second account further comprises:

selecting a highest priority presence status among a plurality of application present statuses of a plurality of communication applications associated with the second account.

20. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 16, wherein determining the presence status of the second account further comprises:

identify, among a plurality of application present statuses of a plurality of communication applications associated with the second account, a subset of communication applications connectable to or more communication applications running on a client device associated with the first account; and

selecting a highest priority presence status among a subset of application present statuses of the subset of communication applications.